

Plug & Earn

Build the marketplace that lets electric fleets sell stored energy back to the grid.

THE SITUATION

Electric vehicles (EVs) sit parked and idle for around 22 hours a day. That's a lot of battery capacity doing nothing. Meanwhile, the electricity grid constantly struggles to balance supply and demand: too much solar energy at noon, not enough power in the evening. Vehicle-to-Grid (V2G) is the idea that a parked EV can charge when energy is cheap, then sell energy back to the grid when it's needed. Using the EV battery as energy storage. The car earns money. The grid gets the flexibility it needs. The problem? The platform to make this happen doesn't exist yet.

1.4M+ EVs parked idle daily in Germany | **22 hrs** parked on average per day | **~1.8% / yr** extra battery degradation from daily V2G use

YOUR CHALLENGE

Build a digital B2B marketplace where EV fleet operators can offer their battery capacity, and energy buyers (grid operators, utilities) can purchase that flexibility. Think of it like Airbnb for battery storage. You're not building the hardware. You're building the platform that connects the two sides.

THREE CONSTRAINTS

- **Digital product only.**
- **B2B only.** Your paying customer is a company (fleet operator, energy supplier, grid operator), not an individual driver.
- **V2G at the core.** Your solution must be built around EV batteries actively storing and releasing energy, not just consuming it.

V2G regulation and technology are genuinely complex. Use the provided resources and your own research to get enough context for credible decisions.

WHAT YOU NEED TO DELIVER

1. **Problem and customer pair.** Who has a real problem here, and how do you know? Talk to at least one real person: a fleet manager, energy professional, or someone close to this space. One real conversation beats hours of desk research.
2. **Solution with a clear value proposition.** What are you building, for whom, and why does it matter? Pick one specific customer type and make the case for them.
3. **Working demo or prototype.** Show the core idea in a way someone can experience.

DATA AND TOOLS PROVIDED

- **Real grid data (SMARD.de).** Official German electricity market data. 15-minute intervals, day-ahead prices, renewable share, grid load. The demand side of your marketplace: what the grid pays for flexibility at any moment. Free, no account needed.
- **Synthetic fleet charging dataset.** ~8,000 synthetic EV charging sessions over 6 months in the Rhein-Main region. Includes timestamps, location, kWh delivered, battery capacity, and state of charge. The supply side: what a fleet's available battery capacity looks like over time.
- **Battery degradation data.** Open datasets for modelling how V2G use affects battery health. Includes a ready-to-use Python model. Key reference: daily V2G use adds ~1.8% additional capacity loss per year vs. EV-only use.
- **Context document.** Briefing on the German balancing energy market, how two-sided energy marketplaces work in practice, and V2G pilots in Europe. Provided at kickoff.

HOW YOU WILL BE EVALUATED

- **Problem validation.** Did you validate a real pain point on both sides: fleet operators (supply) and grid/energy buyers (demand)? Show evidence.
- **Solution quality.** Is the marketplace concept original and well-reasoned? Does it address the cold-start problem: Why would the first seller join before any buyers exist, and vice versa? Show how you would get your first customer on each side. A named first customer and a believable first step wins over a theoretical argument.
- **Prototype tangibility.** Did you build something concrete, such as an enrolment flow, a matching interface, or an earnings simulator?
- **Business potential.** Is there a credible path to revenue? Is the network effect logic sound?
- **Presentation and team.** Is the presentation clear, compelling, and delivered with confidence?

PARTNER

Next Mobility Labs (NML) is a venture studio for start-ups in the mobility ecosystem. Working alongside founders and industry partners, Next Mobility Labs develops, validates, and scales new companies as a co-founder, with a focus on next-generation mobility. Behind the venture studio stands an international network of more than 30 active and former C-level executives from OEMs, suppliers, and digital mobility companies.

Next Mobility Labs supports ventures from the identification of relevant market opportunities through validation and company building all the way to growth and scaling. By closely combining industry access, operational execution, and entrepreneurial experience, the venture studio brings innovations to market together with founders — faster and more sustainably.